END USER COMPUTING.

BICT 1101

Lecture 6: Internet Search (Searching for Information on the Web)

Search

- to carefully look for someone or something : to try to find someone or something.
- search is the process of looking for something or someone.

Using Search Engines to *Find Information on the Web*

- *Search* engine is a software system that is designed to *search for information* on the World Wide *Web*.
- A computer program that is used to look for information on the Internet.
- A computer program which finds information on the Internet by looking for words that users have typed
- A site on the World Wide Web that uses software to locate key words in other sites.

- A type of website that helps a computer user find information on the Internet.
- Search engines are useful to find information about anything quickly and easily.

Examples of Search Engines

- www.google.com
- www.ask.com
- www.bing.com
- www.msn.com
- www.yahoo.com
  - https://search.yahoo.com/

- Search engine - looks through other web pages for the text the user wants to find.
- To use a search engine you must enter at least one keyword into the search box.
- An on-screen button must be clicked on to submit the search or pressing Enter key.
- Search engine looks for matches between the keyword(s) entered in its database of websites and words.

- After a search is submitted search engine results page will appear on screen.
- Results page is a list of webpages that contain matches to the keywords that were searched.
- A user can click on any of the links to go to one of the websites.
- The words you type into the search box are called "keywords."
- Search engine retrieves a list of documents containing the specified keywords.
- The keywords you use will greatly affect your results.

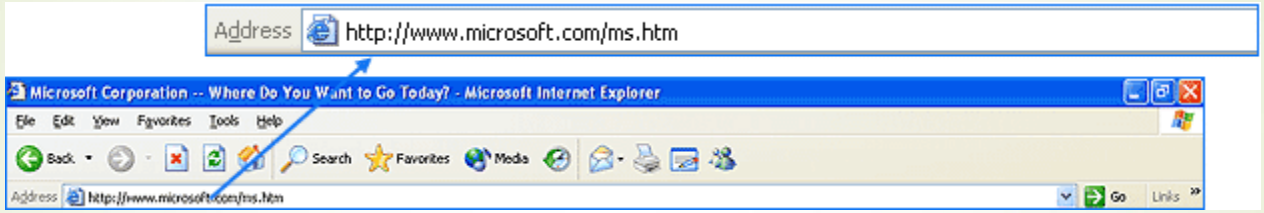
When Searching for Information on the Web

- **Identify your concepts** (idea)
  - E.g. Clinton, Republicans, Budget
- **List keywords for each concept**
  - For example:
    - Budget Negotiations
      Budget Battle
- **Specify the logical relationships among your keywords**
  - Boolean logic allows you to specify the relationships among search terms by using any of three logical operators: **AND, OR, NOT.**

How do you search for info on the internet?

- Using the address bar
- Phrase searching
- Using Boolean operators
- Using the Google Advanced Search Option

Searching using the address bar



Write Website address(URL) in the address bar.

Phrase searching

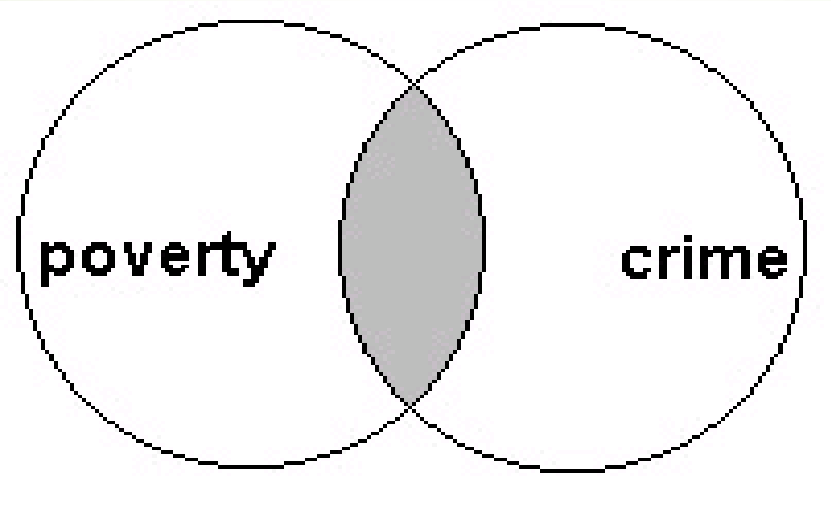
- Requires all your search terms to appear in exactly the order you enter them.
- Enclose the term in double quotations e.g. “instructional design ”

Searching using Boolean Operators

- A type of *search that* allow users to combine keywords with operators such as AND, NOT and OR to produce more relevant results.
- You can use **Boolean operators** to either narrow or broaden search results.
- Boolean operators are:
  - AND
  - OR
  - NOT

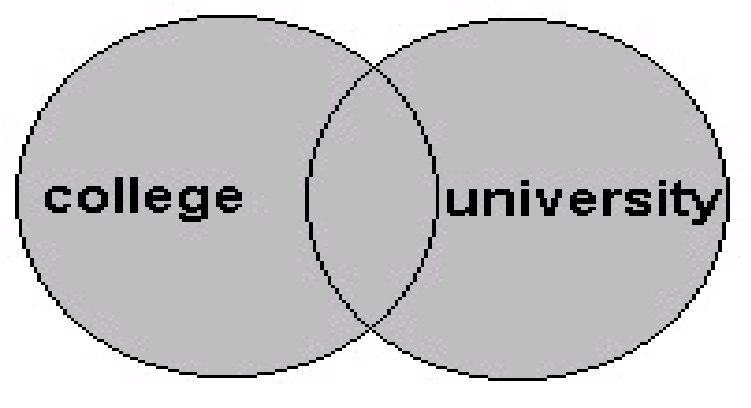
AND operator

- **AND** finds pages containing all your words.
- Use **AND** to narrow your search: all of your search terms will be present in the retrieved records.
- The oval in the middle of the Venn diagram below represents the result set for this search.
- It is the combination of these two search terms.



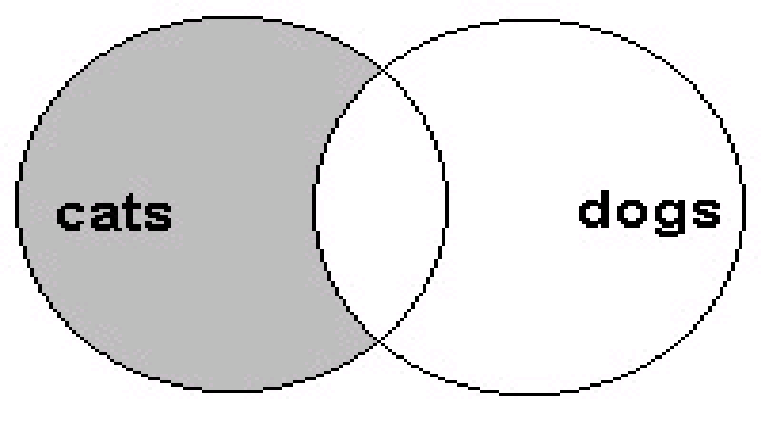
OR operator

- **OR** finds pages containing any of your words
- Use **OR** to broaden your search by connecting two or more synonyms.
- The database retrieves all unique records containing one term, the other or both.



NOT operator

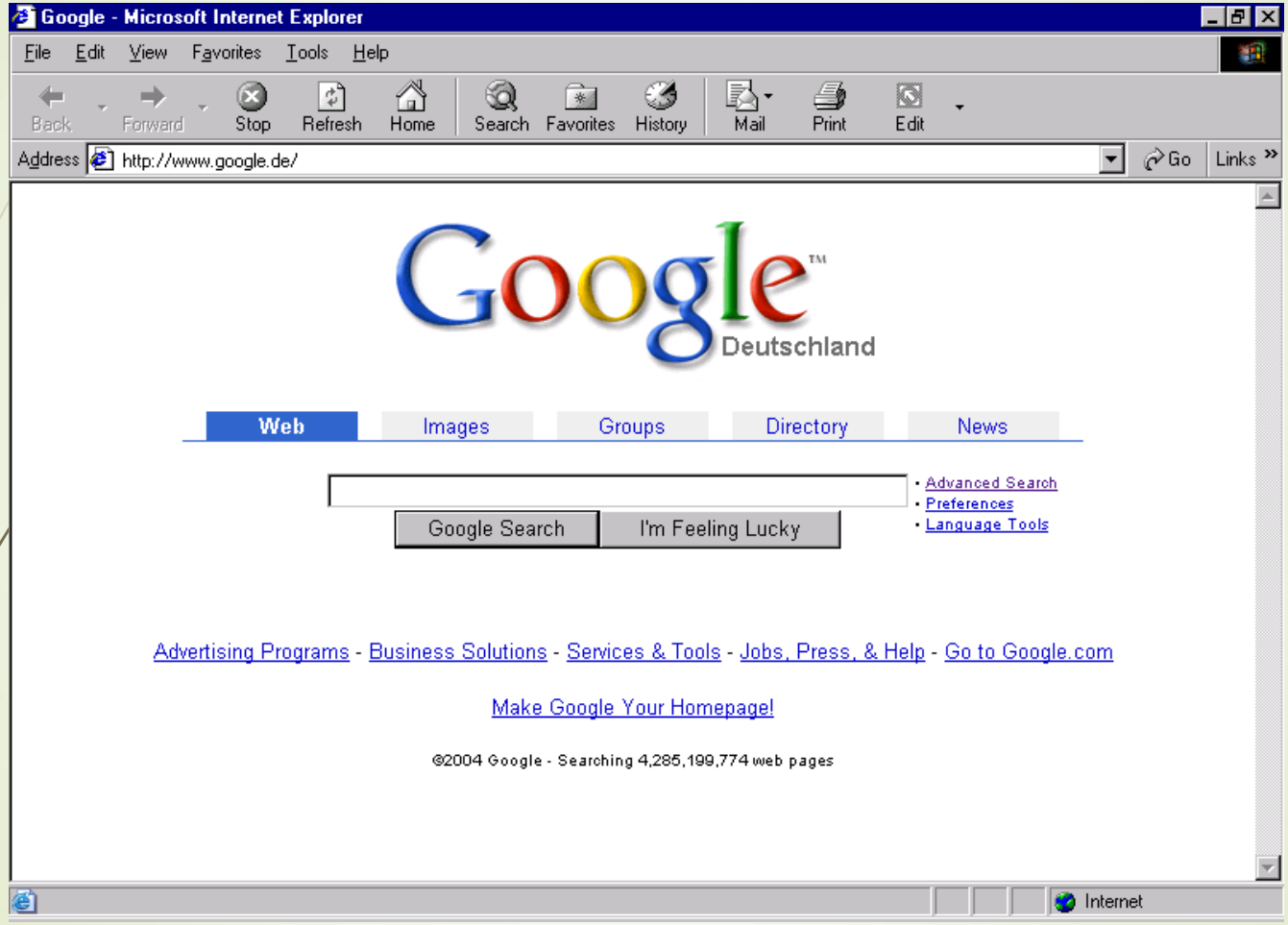
- Use **NOT** to exclude term(s) from your search results.
- NOT - excludes any page containing that word (use cautiously!)



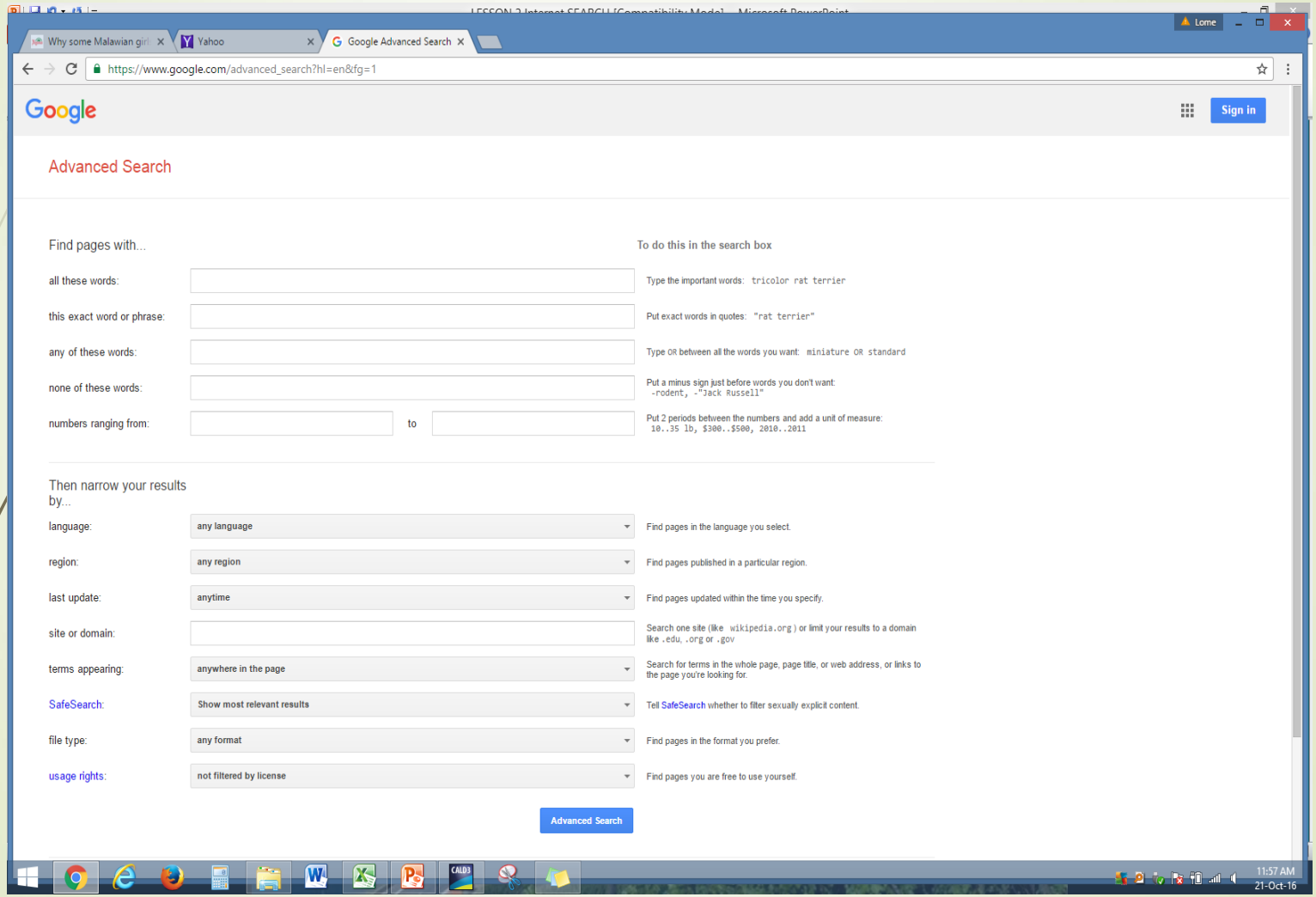
Combining Boolean Operators

- Boolean Operators can be combined e.g. (Women or jobs) and Malawi.
- You can use parenthesis or combine directly.
- Helpful when you are not sure of the spelling e.g. (Sarajevo or Sarayevo) and human rights.

Using Google Advanced Search Option



Gives you a number of ways to limit your search



Subject Directory

Definition:

- A subject directory is a service that offers a collection of links to Internet resources submitted by site creators or evaluators and organized into subject categories.
- A *subject directory* is an online database of web sites and online information set up by subject and category.
- Searches need to be less specific than search engines.
- For general, research oriented queries, and when you want to view sites often recommended by experts, use a subject directory

Subject Directory

- There are two basic types of directories:
  - *academic and*
  - *professional directories.*
- Directories are often created and maintained by subject experts to support the needs of researchers.
- INFOMINE (http://infomine.ucr.edu/), from University of California - an academic subject directory.

Welcome to INFOMINE: Scholarly Internet Resource Collections - Microsoft Internet Explorer

File Edit View Favorites Tools Help

Back Search Favorites Media

Address http://infomine.ucr.edu/ Go Links

124,054 Academically Valuable Resources

Search for: GO

Advanced Search | Search Tips

Celebrating Ten Years of Service!

Browse or Search by Subject Category:

- Bio, Ag & Med Sciences
- Business & Economics
- Cultural Diversity
- Ejournals
- Government Info
- Maps & GIS
- PhysSci, Engr, CS & Math
- SocSci & Humanities
- Visual & Performing Arts

Internet

Google Directory

Web | Images | Groups | Directory | News

Google Search

- Preferences
- Directory Help

The web organized by topic into categories.

Arts
Movies, Music, Television,...

Business
Industries, Finance, Jobs,...

Computers
Hardware, Internet, Software,...

Games
Board, Roleplaying, Video,...

Health
Alternative, Fitness, Medicine,...

Home
Consumers, Homeowners, Family,...

Kids and Teens
Computers, Entertainment, School,...

News
Media, Newspapers, Current Events,...

Recreation
Food, Outdoors, Travel,...

Reference
Education, Libraries, Maps,...

Regional
Asia, Europe, North America,...

Science
Biology, Psychology, Physics,...

Shopping
Autos, Clothing, Gifts,...

Society
Issues, People, Religion,...

Sports
Basketball, Football, Soccer,...

World
Deutsch, Español, Français, Italiano, Japanese, Korean, Nederlands, Polska, Svenska, ...

CRITICAL EVALUATION
Why Evaluate What You Find on the Web?

- Anyone can put up a Web page about anything for money in minutes.
- Many web pages are not kept up-to-date.
- No quality control.